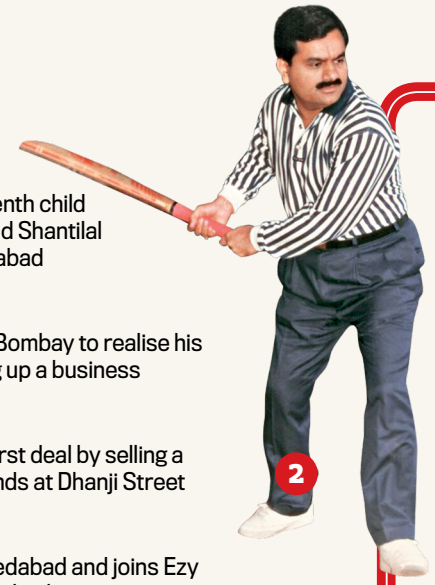
THE RISE AND RISE OF GAUTAM ADANI

Slow and steady...the journey to become the world's third richest person

1962

June 24: Gautam Adani is born as the seventh child to Shantaben and Shantilal Adani at Ahmedabad



1978

A 16, leaves for Bombay to realise his dream of setting up a business

1979

Negotiates his first deal by selling a parcel of diamonds at Dhanji Street

1982

Returns to Ahmedabad and joins Ezy Packaging, a family plastic processing unit; takes charge of procurement and marketing



1986

Apr. 1: Adani Agency and Adani Associates are formed for export/ import of plastics, metals, pharmaceuticals, etc.

May 1: Marries Pritiben Vora in Ahmedabad

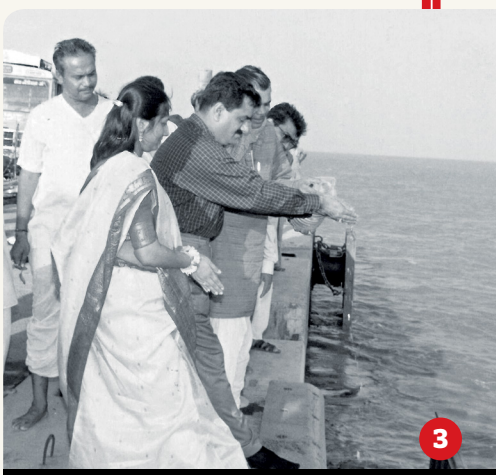
1987

Apr. 7: Their first child, son Karan, is born

1988

Nov. 1: Adani Exports, founded in March, lists on the BSE; IPO oversubscribed by 25 times

Nov. 7: Second son Jeet is born



A LIFE IN PICTURES

1. Adani with his father (1989), **2.** playing cricket at an inhouse league (1996), **3.** inaugurating jetty at Mundra (1998), **4.** holding granddaughter Gayatri, **5.** signing the Holcim deal (2022)

largest marine services company, a transmission project and media company NDTV. All this despite the lingering Covid pandemic and a still raging war in Ukraine that continues to cause global disruptions in business.

The Adani Group has grown at an astonishing pace despite hurdles and strife. In a little over a decade, Adani has become India's largest private sector power producer, port operator, airport operator, consumer gas business and electric transmission company, apart from being the largest infrastructure developer and generator of renewable energy. If Adani was the poster boy of the 1991 reforms, today, with his Midas touch, he is the epitome of the India story–a self-made billionaire who carved out a gigantic, diverse empire in less than three decades. He now has global ambitions and is braced to deal with the stiff resistance his ventures face abroad (and sometimes even in India). As he told INDIA TODAY, "Giving up has never been part of the Adani culture. Having honed my skills in a dynamic democracy like India, me and my group are confident we can deliver and do business in any part of the world. I have faced adversity and crisis from childhood. Each occasion taught me several valuable lessons and made me stronger (see interview: *'I always tell my team–never waste a crisis'*)."

THE MEANING OF MONEY

When Adani speaks, he does so with a quiet conviction, and a disarming candour. He knows he has arrived but that hasn't changed the simplicity with which he expresses his feelings or the humility with which he answers criticisms against his business empire. The walls of his 16th floor office are lined with massive paintings by well-known artists but Adani admits he can't recall half their names. He shuns parties and rather than use his fleet of expensive cars prefers to come to office in a jet-black, bulletproof Toyota Alphard with a convoy of bodyguards accompanying him. The VIP entrance of his HQ bears a large fibreglass sculpture done by Indian Gond and Australian Aboriginal artistes that celebrates two diverse cultures separated